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Section Title(S): The Joking Relationship

Sex is not the differentiating factor with respect to the joking relationship among groups of consanguineous kin and affines other than ego's siblings or his spouse's siblings. Ego's joking status is the same with both persons of a married couple among kin and affines. In other words, if ego refrains from joking with an uncle, he also refrains from joking with the uncle's wife. A man jokes with his brother and with his brother's wife. He refrains from joking with his sister and his sister's husband, and so forth. However, in the name-relationship (see "The Homonymous Method," below), ego assumes his status with the name-relative, male or female, individually on the basis of the individual's name, and he does not necessarily accord the same status to the husband and wife.

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Informants, trying to explain the joking relationship to me, had an additional statement to make about the prohibition of joking. They said that just as they must not joke with their own parents or offspring, they must not joke with both a person and that person's offspring. When the homonymous method is in operation and persons may be taken out of their biological, generational position and given their terminological position through their names, configurations of terms can occur, theoretically, in which ego might joke with a person and his offspring. (I did not confirm this point with actual tests.) The homonymous method is never applied to the nuclear family, nor to primary affines, so in those categories, ego never jokes both with a person and his offspring. It does not follow that if ego does *not* joke with a person he *must* alternate the generations [208](#) and joke with the offspring of that person—he may *avoid joking* with both, as, for instance, a man avoids joking both with his sister and with his sister's offspring, and a woman avoids joking with her brother and his offspring.

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